



## Clinical UM Guideline

**Subject:** External Infusion Pumps for the Administration of Drugs in the Home or Residential Care Settings

**Guideline #:** CG-DME-21

**Status:** Reviewed

**Publish Date:** 01/06/2026

**Last Review Date:**

11/06/2025

### Description

This document addresses the use of external infusion pumps for the administration of parenteral or enteral drugs in the home or other residential care settings for diagnoses other than diabetes mellitus or pulmonary hypertension. The administration of oral or enteral nutrition is not addressed in this document.

**Note:** Please see the following documents for further information regarding other types or uses for infusion pumps:

- [CG-DME-42 Continuous Glucose Monitoring Devices](#)
- [CG-DME-50 Automated Insulin Delivery Systems](#)
- [CG-DME-51 External Insulin Pumps](#)
- [CG-MED-23 Home Health](#)

**Note:** Please see the following document for information regarding the administration of oral or enteral nutrition:

- [CG-MED-08 Home Enteral Nutrition](#)

### Clinical Indications

#### Medically Necessary:

An external infusion pump is considered **medically necessary** for the administration of *intravenous* medications if *either* of the following sets of criteria (Criteria set 1 OR Criteria set 2) is met:

##### Criteria set 1

- Parenteral administration of the drug in the home is reasonable and necessary; **and**
- An infusion pump is necessary to safely administer the drug; **and**
- The drug is administered by a prolonged infusion of at least 8 hours because of proven improved clinical efficacy; **and**
- The therapeutic regimen is proven or generally accepted to have significant advantages over intermittent bolus administration regimens or infusions lasting less than 8 hours.

##### Criteria set 2

- Parenteral administration of the drug in the home is reasonable and necessary; **and**
- An infusion pump is necessary to safely administer the drug; **and**
- The drug is administered by intermittent infusion (each episode of infusion lasting less than 8 hours) that does not require the individual to return to the physician's office prior to the beginning of each infusion; **and**
- Systemic toxicity or adverse effects of the drug are unavoidable without infusing it at a strictly controlled rate as indicated in the Prescribers' Digital Reference.

An external infusion pump is considered **medically necessary** for the administration of *enteral* medications when all of the following criteria have been met:

- The infusion pump is necessary to safely administer the drug; **and**
- The drug is administered in a time and rate limited infusion in accordance with its U.S. Food & Drug Administration (FDA) prescribing information label.

#### Not Medically Necessary:

External infusion pumps and related supplies are considered **not medically necessary** when the criteria described above are not met.

An external infusion pump is considered **not medically necessary** for the administration of enteral medications when the criteria above have not been met.

## Coding

*The following codes for treatments and procedures applicable to this document are included below for informational purposes. Inclusion or exclusion of a procedure, diagnosis or device code(s) does not constitute or imply member coverage or provider reimbursement policy. Please refer to the member's contract benefits in effect at the time of service to determine coverage or non-coverage of these services as it applies to an individual member.*

### When services may be Medically Necessary when criteria are met:

#### HCPCS

|       | <i>Equipment</i>                                                                                                                    |
|-------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| E0776 | IV pole                                                                                                                             |
| E0779 | Ambulatory infusion pump, mechanical, reusable, for infusion 8 hours or greater                                                     |
| E0780 | Ambulatory infusion pump, mechanical, reusable, for infusion less than 8 hours                                                      |
| E0781 | Ambulatory infusion pump, single or multiple channels, electric or battery operated, with administrative equipment, worn by patient |
| E0791 | Parenteral infusion pump, stationary, single or multi-channel                                                                       |

|       | <i>Supplies</i>                                                                      |
|-------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A4221 | Supplies for maintenance of drug infusion catheter, per week (list drug separately)  |
| A4222 | Supplies for external drug infusion pump, per cassette or bag (list drug separately) |
| K0552 | Supplies for external drug infusion pump, syringe type cartridge, sterile, each      |

#### ICD-10 Diagnosis

All diagnoses

### When services are Not Medically Necessary:

For the procedure codes listed above when criteria are not met or for situations designated in the Clinical Indications section as not medically necessary.

## Discussion/General Information

An ambulatory infusion pump is an electrical or battery operated device that is used to deliver solutions containing a drug under pressure at a regulated flow rate. It is small, portable, and designed to be carried by the individual being treated.

A stationary infusion pump is an electrical device that serves the same purpose as an ambulatory pump but is larger and typically mounted on a pole.

A reusable mechanical infusion pump is a device used to deliver solutions containing drugs under pressure at a constant flow rate determined by the tubing with which it is used. It is small, portable, and designed to be carried by the individual being treated. It must be capable of a single infusion cycle of at least 8 hours.

## Definitions

Enteral: Route of administration through the gastrointestinal tract.

Parenteral: Route of administration other than the gastrointestinal tract (for example, intravenous, intramuscular, intraperitoneal).

## References

### Government Agency, Medical Society, and Other Authoritative Publications:

- Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services. National Coverage Determinations. Available at: <https://www.cms.gov/medicare-coverage-database/search.aspx>. Accessed on October 3, 2025.
  - Durable Medical Equipment Reference List. NCD #280.1. Effective June 9, 2025.
  - Infusion Pumps. NCD #280.14. Effective December 17, 2004.
- Carbidopa and levodopa (Duopa) [Product Information], North Chicago, IL. AbbieVie Inc. January 31, 2015. Available at: [https://www.accessdata.fda.gov/drugsatfda\\_docs/label/2015/203952s000lbl.pdf](https://www.accessdata.fda.gov/drugsatfda_docs/label/2015/203952s000lbl.pdf). Accessed on October 3, 2025.

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### External Infusion Pumps

## History

| Status   | Date       | Action                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|----------|------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Reviewed | 11/06/2025 | Medical Policy & Technology Assessment Committee MPTAC review. Revised References section.                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Reviewed | 11/14/2024 | MPTAC review. Updated References sections.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Reviewed | 11/09/2023 | MPTAC review. Updated Description and References sections.                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Reviewed | 11/10/2022 | MPTAC review. Updated References section.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Reviewed | 11/11/2021 | MPTAC review. Updated References section.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Reviewed | 11/05/2020 | MPTAC review. Updated Clinical Indications section and changed "Physicians' Desk Reference" to "Prescribers' Digital Reference". Updated References section. Reformatted Coding section; removed codes K0601-K0605.                                                           |
| Reviewed | 11/07/2019 | MPTAC review. Updated References section.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Reviewed | 11/08/2018 | MPTAC review. Updated Description, Definitions, and References sections.                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Reviewed | 01/27/2017 | MPTAC review. The document header wording updated from "Current Effective Date" to "Publish Date."                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Revised  | 02/02/2017 | MPTAC review. Made minor typographical revision to Clinical Indications. Updated References section.                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Revised  | 02/04/2016 | MPTAC review. Minor language clarification made in Medically Necessary Section. Removed ICD-9 codes from Coding section.                                                                                                                                                      |
| Revised  | 02/05/2015 | MPTAC review. Revised Title and Description sections to clarify scope of document. Added new medically necessary and not medically necessary statements for continuous administration of enteral drugs. Added Definitions section. Updated Rationale and References sections. |
| Reviewed | 08/14/2014 | MPTAC review.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Reviewed | 11/14/2013 | MPTAC review.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Reviewed | 11/08/2012 | MPTAC review. Updated References section.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Reviewed | 11/17/2011 | MPTAC review. Updated References section.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Reviewed | 11/17/2010 | MPTAC review. Updated References section.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Reviewed | 11/19/2009 | MPTAC review. Updated References section.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Reviewed | 11/20/2008 | MPTAC review.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Reviewed | 11/29/2007 | MPTAC review. References updated. Minor formatting changes.                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Reviewed | 12/07/2006 | MPTAC review. References updated.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| New      | 12/01/2005 | MPTAC initial guideline development.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |

| Pre-Merger Organizations | Last Review Date | Document Number | Title                   |
|--------------------------|------------------|-----------------|-------------------------|
| Anthem, Inc.             |                  |                 | No document             |
| Anthem CO/NV             | 10/29/2004       | DME.217         | External Infusion Pumps |

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Alternatively, commercial or FEP plans or lines of business which determine there is not a need to adopt the guideline to review services generally across all providers delivering services to Plan's or line of business's members may instead use the clinical guideline for provider education and/or to review the medical necessity of services for any provider who has been notified that his/her/its claims will be reviewed for medical necessity due to billing practices or claims that are not consistent with other providers, in terms of frequency or in some other manner.

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